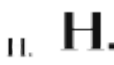


STAGE 1 · TOP FIVE CONCEPTS, RANKED

Five ways to say “grounded intelligence”.

The three routes already reviewed, plus the two strongest ideas held back from the first round: **Ground Truth** and **Horizon Line**. Ranked on relevance, distinctiveness, craft, small-scale performance and system potential. All marks are outlined vector artwork, shown flat in black on white.

No 1 High Bar CUSTOM TYPOGRAPHIC	No 2NEW Ground Truth FIELD AND OBSERVATION	No 3 Rise LAND AND OBSERVATION	No 4NEW Horizon Line EVOLUTION OF THE CURRENT LOGO	No 5 The Point ALTERNATIVE INTERPRETATION
				
				
COMPACT · 16 AND 32 PX ACTUAL	COMPACT · 16 AND 32 PX ACTUAL	COMPACT · 16 AND 32 PX ACTUAL	COMPACT · 16 AND 32 PX ACTUAL	COMPACT · 16 AND 32 PX ACTUAL
The horizon, drawn into the H.	The map, checked on the ground.	A field boundary from above; rising ground from the side.	Keep the horizon; lose the mountain.	Every visit ends in a point.

№ 1 · CUSTOM TYPOGRAPHIC

High Bar

HCO High Country
Observations

THE IDEA

A custom-drawn HCO in which the crossbar of the H sits high — the horizon as you see it from high ground, with more land in view than sky. That one line becomes the system: layouts hang their content below the same high horizon, and photographs are cropped the same way.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

The idea lives in a single detail. Without the system around it, some people will simply see a well-drawn HCO, and a crossbar pushed any higher starts to look like a period mannerism.

WHY № 1

Strongest on every test, and the idea lives in the name itself — it cannot be separated from HCO or copied onto someone else's initials.

REPORT COVER STUDY · ILLUSTRATIVE



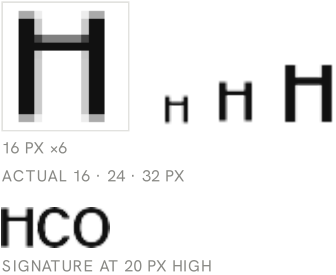
REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



Field &
Operations
Review

№ 2 · FIELD AND OBSERVATION

Ground Truth



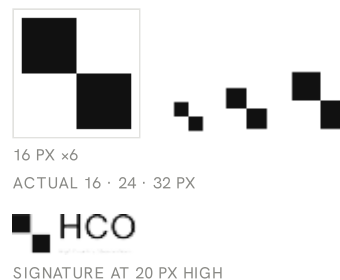
REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



THE IDEA

In drone mapping, a two-square target is laid on the ground so the aerial map can be pinned to real positions: the picture from above, checked against the ground. That is HCO's promise in one object. The point where the squares meet marks exact locations in every map, photograph and report.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

Two squares are simple, common geometry. Repeated, they read as a racing flag, and the reference could imply surveying services HCO does not offer. It has to be owned through disciplined use and never tiled into a pattern.

WHY № 2

The most business-specific symbol and the best performer at 16 px. It ranks below High Bar because the form itself is generic and must be earned through use.

REPORT COVER STUDY · ILLUSTRATIVE



№ 3 · LAND AND OBSERVATION

Rise



THE IDEA

One line, read two ways. From above it is a boundary between fields; from the side it is ground rising to high country. The symbol is a change of perspective — the map and the ground, the plan and the section — which is exactly what HCO's work brings together.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

Abstract geometry is easily misread: at a glance the line can look like a step chart or a stair, and rising-line marks are common in consulting. It needs the two-tone version or real context to read as land.

WHY № 3

The richest idea of the five, but the one most likely to be misread without explanation — a risk for a mark that often appears alone.

REPORT COVER STUDY · ILLUSTRATIVE



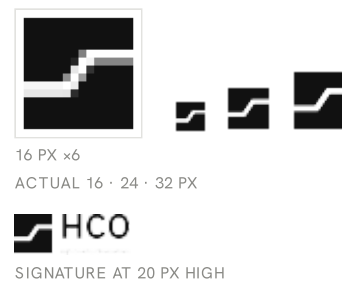
REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



№ 4 · EVOLUTION OF THE CURRENT LOGO

Horizon Line



THE IDEA

The evolution route. It keeps what the current logo got right — a horizon over the name — and drops what works against it: the stock peak, the gold on black and the fragile type. The single line runs to the edge of every format, because HCO looks past the field to the wider system.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

A rule over a serif name is a familiar device, so this is the least distinctive of the five, and it keeps the brand close to the current logo's formal, heritage tone.

WHY № 4

The safest step from today's logo — worth having if continuity matters to HCO's existing clients — but High Bar makes the same horizon idea far more ownable.

REPORT COVER STUDY · ILLUSTRATIVE



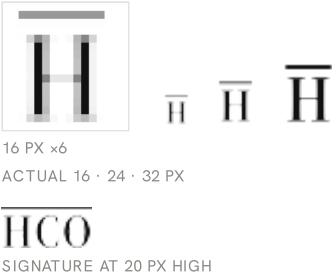
REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



№ 5 · ALTERNATIVE INTERPRETATION

The Point

HCO.

REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



16 PX ×6

ACTUAL 16 · 24 · 32 PX

HCO.

SIGNATURE AT 20 PX HIGH

THE IDEA

HCO's real product is clarity: after the visit you know what the issue is and what to do next. The identity is plain-spoken — a confident serif name closed by a square point, the same point that marks each observation on a map and ends each recommendation.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

Full-stop wordmarks are a familiar device, and a square alone is too generic to own. The compact mark is the weakest of the five, and the serif leans further towards editorial than field.

WHY № 5

A strong verbal idea with the weakest mark: it would rely on copy and layout to do the work a logo should.

REPORT COVER STUDY · ILLUSTRATIVE

HCO.

Field & Operations
Review.

COMPARISON · INTERNAL WORKING VIEW

How the five compare

	No 1 · HIGH BAR	No 2 · GROUND TRUTH	No 3 · RISE	No 4 · HORIZON LINE	No 5 · THE POINT
BUSINESS RELEVANCE	Translates the name; plain enough for a truck door or a lender's desk.	Names the promise exactly; leans to the field half of the work.	Plan and section; says less about the advisory half.	Continuity with today; says little new.	Advisory value; least about land.
DISTINCTIVENESS	A raised crossbar is rare and ownable without a symbol.	Specific story, common geometry.	Steps and rising lines are common forms.	A rule over a serif name is familiar.	Full-stop wordmarks are familiar.
TYPOGRAPHIC CRAFT	Drawn lettering; every join controllable.	Well-set type beside a symbol.	Well-set type beside a symbol.	Sturdy serif, set rather than drawn.	Handsome serif; point spacing needs care.
SMALL-SCALE PERFORMANCE	H holds at 16 px; bar legible at 24 px.	Two solid squares: the clearest at 16 px.	The line starts to close at 16 px.	The bar thins to a pixel at 16 px.	"H." reads as an initial at 16 px.
SYSTEM POTENTIAL	One measure organises every format and crop.	Marks exact points on maps and photos; bold on vehicles.	Dividing line and paired images; can repeat.	Flexible line to the edge; little else.	Useful markers; mostly typographic voice.
TOTAL / 25	21	19	17	14	13

Ratings are a designer's judgement from the artwork and the pixel tests on each page, not measured data. A resemblance check against existing identities will be run on the approved concept; it is not trademark clearance.

RECOMMENDATION

No 1 High Bar, with type direction A.

High Bar is the most distinctive without leaning on a symbol, survives at the smallest sizes, and its one idea generates the most useful system — for the advisory half of the business as much as the field half.

If a symbol is wanted as well, **Ground Truth** is the strongest second choice. It should not be merged with High Bar: each works because it does one thing.

TO MOVE TO THE IDENTITY PACK

1 · CHOOSE ONE CONCEPT

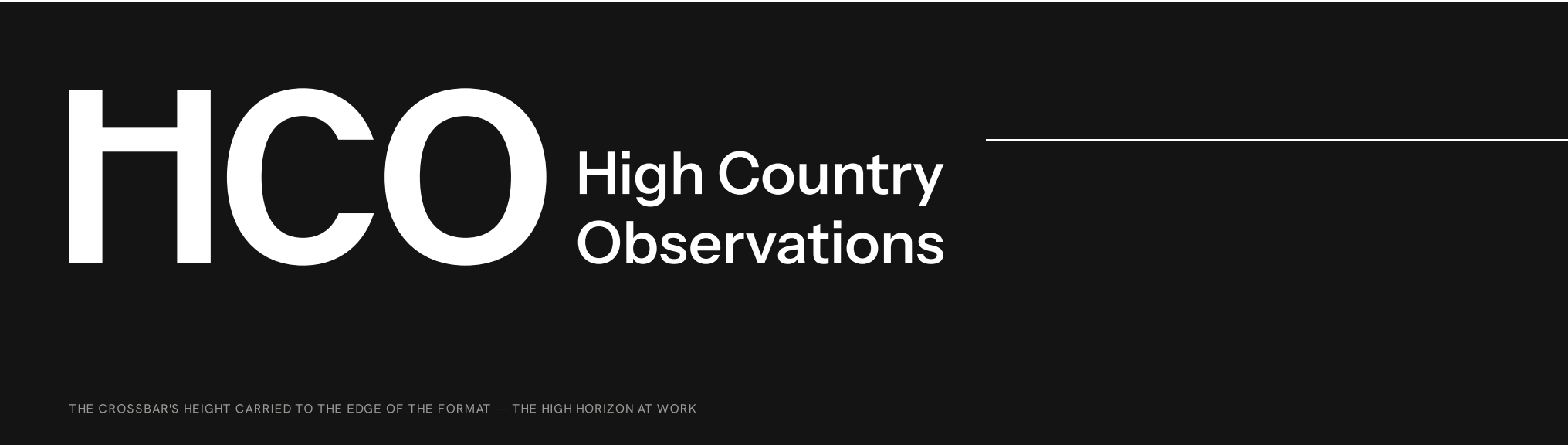
It is then locked; only the craft is refined.

2 · CONFIRM TYPOGRAPHY

Open-licence direction A (Instrument Sans), or a licensed family with approved access. Your premium fonts cannot be reached from this environment.

3 · CONFIRM THE NAME

“Group” or “Consulting”. Until then: HCO, High Country Observations, and Consulting as an optional descriptor.



HCO High Country
Observations

THE CROSSBAR'S HEIGHT CARRIED TO THE EDGE OF THE FORMAT — THE HIGH HORIZON AT WORK